

Dalian Red 5 – 大连红五

A 4-player climbing game with a stripped double deck, solo contracts, and no bombs

Setup

Players: 4. Either everyone plays for themselves, or one **declarer** plays alone against the other three.

Cards: Use 2 standard 54-card decks. Keep only 5s, 10s, J, Q, K, A, 2s, and Jokers. This gives exactly **60 cards**: 8 cards of each kept rank, plus 4 Jokers.

Deal: 15 cards to each player.

First speaker: Mark one of the two **Heart 10s**; its holder declares first. If everyone declines, this player leads; otherwise the declarer leads. House options: use Heart 9 as the marker, or start after the previous declarer.

Card Rank

Highest to lowest: Heart 5 > Big Joker > Small Joker > other 5s > 2 > A > K > Q > J > 10.

The **Heart 5** is separate from the other 5s and cannot combine with other-suit 5s in pairs or same-rank sets.

Declarations

Starting with the special-10 player, each player declares once: either **No Solo** to decline a contract, or a higher contract. Declarations are ranked **from weakest to strongest**.

Declaration	Contract
No Solo	Decline a contract. If everyone chooses this, there is no declarer.
Solo	Declarer must go out before any opponent.
Shutout	Declarer must go out before any opponent has played any card.
Heavenly Shutout	Every declarer play must be unbeatable, including the final play.

Higher contracts override lower ones. The final player to declare Solo or higher becomes **declarer**.

Turn Flow

A lead may be any legal play. On your turn, either **pass** or play a legal combination that **beats the current play**.

If all other active players pass, the last player who played clears the pile and leads again. Passing does **not** lock you out. Players with no cards left drop out and are skipped.

Legal Plays

Play	Requirement
Single	1 card.
Pair	2 equal-rank cards. The two Heart 5s may pair.
Set	3 to 7 equal-rank cards: triple, quad, 5-, 6-, or 7-of-a-kind.
Single run	Exactly 4 or 5 consecutive singles, using only 10, J, Q, K, A.
Connected sets	3+ consecutive groups of the same size, e.g. three pairs, three triples, or three quads. Only 10, J, Q, K, A may be used.

Comparison: A play only beats the **same type** with matching size, length, or structure. Sets compare by rank. Runs and connected sets compare by their highest card or highest group.

No bombs: There are no bombs and no cross-type beating.

Contract End

No Solo: The round ends after three players have gone out; the remaining player is fourth.

Solo: Declarer wins by going out before any opponent. If an opponent goes out first, declarer loses.

Shutout: Declarer wins by going out before any opponent plays any card. If an opponent plays first, declarer loses.

Heavenly Shutout: If any declarer play could be beaten, declarer loses immediately. Opponents do not need to actually play the beating hand.

8-of-a-Kind

There is no playable 8-of-a-kind. If a player is dealt **8 cards of the same rank**, the round ends immediately and that player scores as a **Shutout** winner.

If multiple players have 8-of-a-kind, each scores a separate Shutout win; winners also pay each other.

Scoring

Scores are in base points. Contract scores are paid against each of the three opponents.

Result	Player	Others
No Solo: 1st	+2	–
No Solo: 2nd	+1	–
No Solo: 3rd	–1	–
No Solo: 4th	–2	–
Solo wins	+9	–3 each
Solo loses	–9	+3 each
Shutout wins	+15	–5 each
Shutout loses	–15	+5 each
Heavenly wins	+30	–10 each
Heavenly loses	–30	+10 each